DeepSeek Novelty Judging

Updated progress report and new results

Research purpose and design

Test whether the sensitivity of LLM novelty judgments extends to a Chinese-model judge. I retain the authors' English benchmark and change the judge to DeepSeek. The data include Human-Only and Human+Generated settings; this is not a wholly Chinese-model data-generation pipeline.

Pointwise evaluation asks whether one idea is novel (299 / 308 items); pairwise evaluation chooses between two ideas (154 pairs per setting). The legacy reference uses three pointwise votes or three votes per presentation order for pairwise evaluation. Prompt wording, aggregation, input format and pre-generated negative sources are varied.

Additions since the earlier 37-configuration stage

I completed three Human-Only plan-format conditions (P3, P4 and P5), bringing the source matrix to 40 configurations. Following the authors' code, I derived 22 no-aggregation conditions from the saved votes; 18 add distinct conditions after deduplication. I also completed the associated statistics and figures. This document refresh itself adds no new model calls or experimental conditions.

Verified results

40 completed configurations pass item-index, label, vote-count and aggregation checks. The original 37 configurations and three Human-Only plan-prompt supplements are complete. The authors' three-subrun procedure yields 22 no-aggregation conditions, covering 18 additional conditions after deduplication (58 conditions in total).

Setting	Pointwise macro-F1	Pairwise strict	Pairwise soft	Tie rate
Human-Only	0.733	0.812	0.838	5.2%
Human+Generated	0.786	0.662	0.705	8.4%

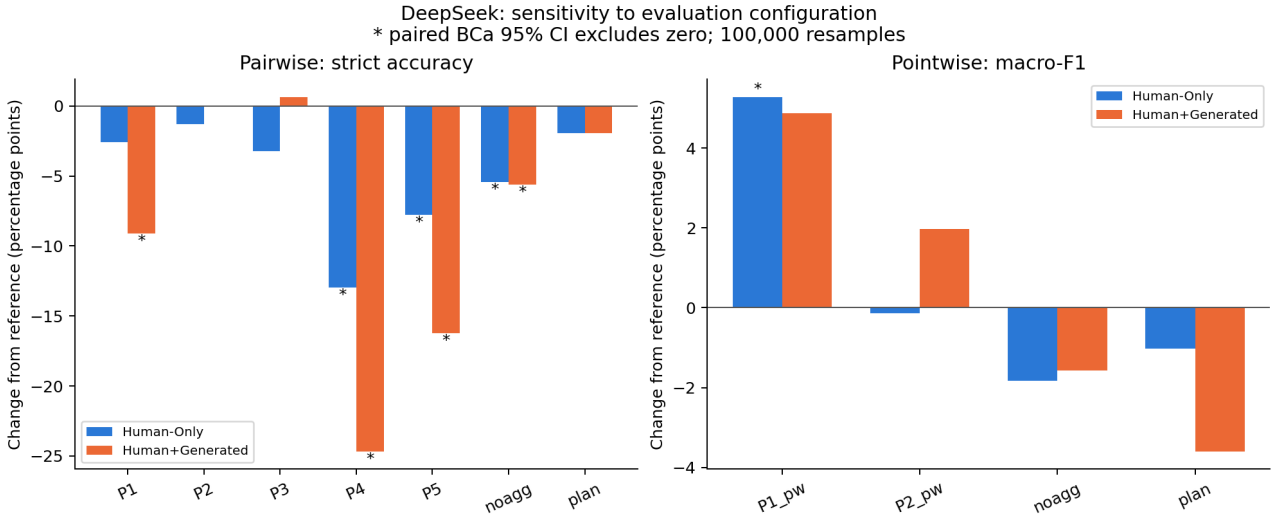


Figure 1. Changes from the reference. Stars indicate paired BCa 95% intervals excluding zero; 100,000 resamples per comparison, without multiple-testing correction.

On Human+Generated data, P4 reduces strict accuracy by **24.68 percentage points** (95% CI: -32.47 to -17.53). This supports prompt sensitivity for this judge and benchmark; it does not establish the true novelty of individual ideas.

Source effects and progress against the paper

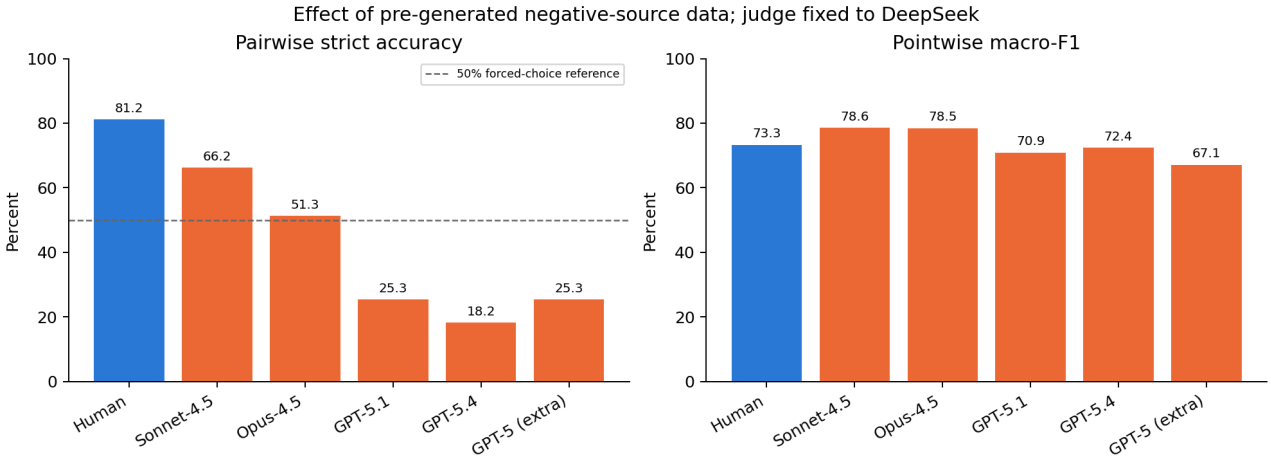


Figure 2. DeepSeek is the fixed judge; the pre-generated negative-source data change. GPT-5 is an extra source. These archived data were reused without calling foreign-model APIs.

Newly completed Human-Only plan results

Plan prompt	Human-Only strict	Human-Only soft	Human+Generated strict
P3	0.727	0.782	0.558
P4	0.675	0.750	0.377
P5	0.734	0.786	0.448

The Human+Generated plan results were already available. The new Human-Only results complete both settings for Fig. 12; cross-setting differences alone do not identify a causal mechanism.

Remaining work

The checklist covers **58 distinct conditions** out of 86 (including two extra GPT-5 source conditions). The remaining 28 comprise eight main ablations, eight no-aggregation derivations dependent on them, six cross-source retrieval conditions, four dedicated-evaluator conditions and two strong-retrieval conditions. Four matched explicit-high references are also needed. This count is not overall paper completion.

Current problems and next steps

Reasoning control: historical calls used an unpinned alias without explicit effort. Low/high probes cannot establish historical behavior; matched references are required.

Retrieval fidelity: the original pipeline uses contributions, five queries, Paper Finder and a 2025-03-01 cutoff. Retrieval and dedicated evaluators still need implementation and cost measurement.

Evidence limits: labels and expert validation are inherited; some historical responses are missing and parsers changed. Strict accuracy counts ties as zero, so scores below 0.5 alone do not prove reversed preferences.

Archive: 120 paired BCa comparisons, 100,000 resamples each; no multiple-testing adjustment. Source runs, three-subrun derivations and supplementary fresh repeats remain separate. This is a selected single-judge replication.

Source: Sternlicht et al., Old Ideas, Novel Problems: The Instability of LLM-Based Novelty Evaluation, arXiv:2610.02022v1. Benchmark: huggingface.co/datasets/noystl/novelty-judge-bench. Code: github.com/Viego051115/novelty-eval-replication.